Bridging continents through trade, partnership, and shared prosperity

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August 2026

Foreword

The Dominican Republic is the largest economy in the Caribbean and one of the most dynamic in Latin America, anchored by a mature tourism sector, an internationally competitive free trade zone regime, expanding mining and agro-industrial output, and a strategic geographic position at the crossroads of North American, Latin American, and European trade routes. India, for its part, brings globally competitive strengths in pharmaceuticals, generic medicines, information technology, agricultural machinery, automotive components, renewable energy equipment, and business process services. The complementarity between the two economies is substantial and, to date, underutilised.

This Knowledge Paper has been prepared as a working document for CCI India's member companies, for government stakeholders in India, and for the Embassy of the Dominican Republic in New Delhi. It examines the Dominican Republic's economic and business environment in depth, reviews the current state of India-Dominican Republic relations, analyses priority sectors identified in our discussions with the Ambassador, including pharmaceuticals, healthcare, agriculture and farm machinery, logistics, cocoa, cigars, textiles, tourism, and manufacturing, and sets out a detailed roadmap for the role CCI India can play in translating diplomatic goodwill into commercial outcomes.

CCI India is committed to serving as an institutional bridge between Indian industry and the Dominican Republic, through business delegations, buyer-seller meets, investment forums, sector-specific missions, and sustained policy dialogue with both governments. We believe the recommendations contained in this paper offer a practical and actionable framework for deepening trade, investment, and technology cooperation between our two nations over the coming years.

We extend our sincere appreciation to H.E. Francisco Compres H. and the Embassy of the Dominican Republic in India for their partnership in this endeavour, and we look forward to working closely with the Embassy, the Government of India, and our member industries to realise the substantial opportunities that this relationship holds.



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DOMINICAN REPUBLIC

> Go beyond the resorts and experience authentic local life



Basic Facts, Demographics, and Monetary System: The Dominican Republic is located in the Caribbean, occupying the eastern part of the island of Hispaniola, which it shares with Haiti. Its capital is Santo Domingo, the official language is Spanish, and the national currency is the Dominican Peso (DOP). The country has a population of approximately 11.5 million people and is one of the largest economies in the Caribbean. It has a relatively young and urbanizing population, with major cities like Santo Domingo and Santiago serving as key economic and cultural centers. The Dominican Peso is influenced by tourism revenues, remittances, and trade flows, supported by stable monetary policies.

Economic Landscape and Gross Domestic Product (GDP)

The Dominican Republic has one of the fastest-growing economies in Latin America and the Caribbean, with a nominal GDP of around USD 124-127 billion. Its economy is driven by tourism, manufacturing (especially free trade zones), mining, agriculture, construction, and services. Tourism is a major pillar, attracting millions of visitors annually, while manufacturing zones produce textiles, electronics, and medical devices for export. The country has shown strong economic resilience supported by investment, infrastructure development, and trade openness.

The primary sectors contributing to the GDP are:

✦ **Agriculture:** Sugar, coffee, cocoa, tobacco, rice, bananas, avocados, and fruits remain important.

✦ **Services:** Tourism, trade, transport, finance, and communications dominate GDP.

✦ **Industry:** Includes manufacturing, mining (gold,ferronickel, nickel), construction, and energy..

Culture and Heritage

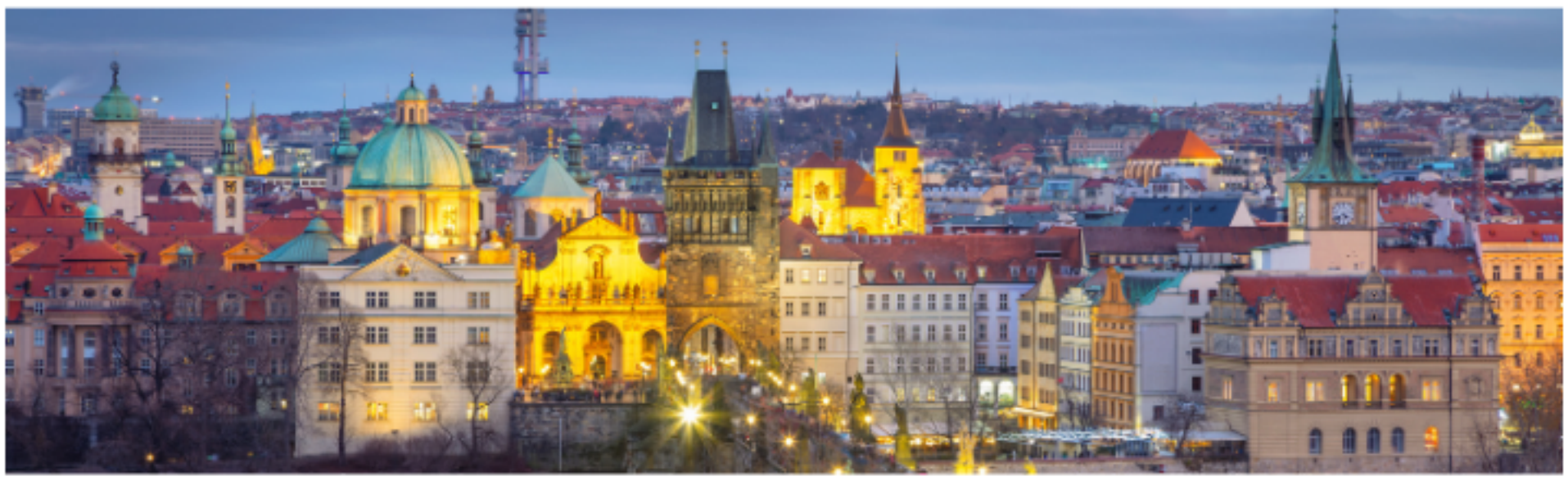
The Dominican Republic has a rich cultural identity shaped by Spanish, African, and Indigenous Taíno influences. It is globally known for music styles such as merengue and bachata, vibrant festivals, and colorful traditions. Its cultural heritage is reflected in dance, cuisine, art, and historic architecture, particularly in Santo Domingo, one of the oldest cities in the Americas.

Import and Export from India

India exports a wide range of goods to the Dominican Republic, including pharmaceuticals, vehicles, machinery, chemicals, textiles, and engineering products that support critical sectors such as healthcare, infrastructure, manufacturing, and consumer markets. These exports play an important role in meeting the country's demand for affordable medicines, industrial equipment, and finished goods. In return, India imports gold, medical devices, electrical equipment, tobacco, and cocoa, tobacco and niche agricultural products from the Dominican Republic. This trade pattern highlights a complementary relationship, where India supplies value-added manufactured goods while the Dominican Republic contributes mineral resources and specialized export products.

Economic Ties

India and the Dominican Republic share warm and steadily expanding economic ties built on trade, industrial cooperation, and mutually beneficial market strengths. India's exports help support the Dominican Republic's industrial development, healthcare systems, and infrastructure needs, while the Dominican Republic provides valuable minerals and niche export goods to Indian markets. Beyond trade, both countries are increasingly exploring collaboration in renewable energy, healthcare, digital technology, infrastructure, pharmaceuticals and ICT development, creating a stronger foundation for long-term economic partnership and investment.



Key Players in Import and Export

Major Indian export players include pharmaceutical companies, automobile manufacturers, machinery exporters, textile producers, and chemical firms that cater to the Dominican Republic's growing industrial and consumer demand. On the Dominican Republic's side, key export players include mining companies involved in gold production, medical device manufacturers, tobacco and cigar producers, and agricultural exporters supplying global markets.

Culture and People-to-People Ties

People-to-people ties between India and the Dominican Republic are growing through diplomatic goodwill, cultural exchange, and educational engagement. Indian culture—such as yoga, cuisine, and films—is gradually gaining visibility, while Dominican music, dance, and cultural traditions are globally recognized.

Chapter 1: Dominican Republic at a Glance

1.1 Geography

The Dominican Republic occupies the eastern two-thirds of the island of Hispaniola in the Greater Antilles, sharing its western land border with the Republic of Haiti. It is the second-largest country in the Caribbean by land area, covering approximately 48,670 square kilometres, and is bordered by the Atlantic Ocean to the north and the Caribbean Sea to the south. The country's terrain is markedly varied for its size, encompassing the Cordillera Central mountain range, home to Pico Duarte, the highest peak in the Caribbean, as well as fertile lowland valleys such as the Cibao Valley, extensive coastal plains, and over 1,600 kilometres of coastline that underpin its tourism industry. The capital, Santo Domingo, situated on the southern coast, is the oldest continuously inhabited European-founded city in the Americas and remains the country's principal political, financial, and commercial centre.

The country's geographic position, at the centre of the Caribbean basin and in close proximity to the United States, Puerto Rico, and the wider Central American and South American markets, gives it strategic relevance as a logistics and re-export hub. This positioning, combined with the country's free trade zone regime and its preferential trade access to North America, is central to the case for the Dominican Republic as a platform for Indian goods seeking wider Caribbean and Central American market access.

1.2 Political System

The Dominican Republic is a representative, unitary, and democratic republic with a presidential system of government, structured around three constitutionally separated branches: executive, legislative, and judicial. The President serves as both head of state and head of government, is elected by direct popular vote for a four-year term, renewable once consecutively, and appoints the Cabinet, provincial governors, and senior officials of the executive branch. The current President, Mr. Luis Abinader of the Partido Revolucionario Moderno (Modern Revolutionary Party, PRM), first took office in August 2020 and secured re-election in the general election of May 2024 with a decisive first-round majority, beginning his second term in August 2024.

The National Congress is bicameral, comprising the Chamber of Deputies and the Senate, both elected for four-year terms concurrent with the presidential term. Following the 2024 elections, the governing PRM holds a substantial majority in both chambers, providing the Abinader administration with a strong legislative mandate.

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